

SUPERSONIC BRAHMOS: INDIA'S 'BRAHMASTRA'

Hon'ble Defence Minister Mr Rajnath Singh being presented a memento by Secretary DDR&D and Chairman DRDO along with Director General (BrahMos), DRDO and CEO & MD, BrahMos Aerospace during the flag-off ceremony of the 1st batch of BRAHMOS Missiles produced at BrahMos Aerospace, Lucknow.

The strength of a modern, powerful nation is reflected in its economic growth backed by a strong military force. A strong military force equipped with cutting-edge technologies, state-of-the-art platforms and systems ensures strategic autonomy and technological sovereignty for a nation.

India's steady rise as a reliable and responsible power of 21st century has been reinforced by its powerful Armed Forces equipped with top-of-the-line platforms, weapons and systems to safeguard national integrity and territorial sovereignty. A top-of-the-line modern kinetic weapon which has not only bolstered India's warfighting capability in an ever-evolving, multi-threat combat environment of contemporary times, but also ensured strategic autonomy and technological sovereignty for the country, is supersonic cruise missile BRAHMOS.

The 'universal', 'combat-proven' tactical missile infused with high-end technologies and unparalleled attributes of speed, stealth, precision and firepower, remains a formidable deterrent weapon of its time. BRAHMOS's multi-platform deployability and multi-domain operability has made it a weapon of choice for India's Tri-Services. Rightly reckoned as the *Brahmastra* in an era of precision warfare and multi-domain operations, BRAHMOS has completed India's 'supersonic cruise missile triad.' Designed and developed as a powerful tactical missile which has redefined the realms of modern warfare, BRAHMOS remains an excellent technological feat born out of a longstanding strategic partnership between India and Russia. The BrahMos Joint Venture (JV) involving India's DRDO and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya (NPOM) is the finest testimony of joint research, joint design, development and successful operationalisation of a high-end weapon in the Indian Armed Forces.

As India and Russia reaffirm their decades-old comprehensive strategic partnership in a swiftly evolving new world order, the BRAHMOS programme continues to remain a crucial pivot in reshaping bilateral ties between the two powerful nations. The BrahMos JV has distinctly stood out as one of the most successful defence ventures worldwide.



Hon'ble Defence Minister Mr Rajnath Singh and Hon'ble Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh Yogi Adityanath jointly flagged off the 1st batch of BRAHMOS Missiles produced at the BrahMos Aerospace Unit in Lucknow Node of Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor on 18 October 2025.

By designing, developing and delivering such an unparalleled weapon, BrahMos Aerospace has maintained its global edge and stayed ahead of the technology curve.

"Supersonic BRAHMOS remains a critical asset in India's overall military strategy and operational planning. As a highly sophisticated system with near-invincible attributes, the precision strike missile has continued to evolve with technological upgrades and validated its superlative performance standards time and again. The indigenous content in the weapon has also increased over the years. BRAHMOS has emerged as India's foremost weapon of choice, ensuring our Armed Force's battle readiness at all times," says Dr. Jaiteerth R. Joshi, DG (BrahMos), DRDO and CEO & MD of BrahMos Aerospace.

In 2022, the JV company successfully entered into the world market of exports after signing a landmark deal with the Republic of the Philippines to deliver shore-based BRAHMOS anti-ship missile batteries to the Armed Forces of Philippines. That historic export order accelerated India's aspiration to strengthen its position as a leading manufacturer and exporter of cutting-edge defence systems in the international arena under the *'Make-In-India'* and *'Make-for-the-World'* vision. Even as the deliveries of BRAHMOS to the Philippines continues and is nearing completion, many other countries across continents have evinced strong interest to acquire the lethal weapon for their military.

At a time when India's defence indigenisation roadmap gathers momentum, the inauguration of a new state-of-the-art BRAHMOS production, integration and testing facility in Lucknow as part of the Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC) in May 2025 has further consolidated BrahMos Aerospace's position to continue manufacturing and delivering the deadly BRAHMOS to the Indian Armed Forces expeditiously. The first batch of BRAHMOS systems have been flagged off from the Lucknow unit in October 2025.

Meanwhile, the BrahMos JV has initiated work on more advanced, futuristic variants of BRAHMOS including the next-generation BRAHMOS (BRAHMOS-NG), which, owing to its compact design, lighter weight, versatility, portability, smart stealth and other enhanced technologies and features, promises to be a new revolutionary inclusion in the battlefields tomorrow.